

It was a complete coincidence that Leah Bassel addressed the Windrush scandal during her lecture “Politics of Listening”. I truly profited from her talk and the exchange on migration. To help us further researching and understanding the Windrush scandal from a broader perspective within the context of commonwealth countries, she shared several websites¹ with us.

For our performance, I attempted to reach out to the researcher’s team to ask for consent to use the interview transcripts and audio recordings. Unfortunately, I did not receive a reply in time. During a feedback session Stefanie informed me about the right of quotation within an educational context, which I decided to use. As Bassel warns that dominant groups frequently only listen when "marginalized" voices fit neat, comfortable stereotypes, it was incredibly important for us to present this audio snippet unedited in full length. I genuinely wanted to give room to someone to speak about their own experiences, thereby challenging the power dynamics of who gets to speak and who gets to edit. This was precisely why we chose this recording and to emphasize that this is not an act of charity. These individuals already have a voice, and our goal was to challenge the audience to truly listen to them.

Regarding the musical audio, I initially faced a steep learning curve with Strudel and learned a lot through tutorials. By the weekend of the first week, I was so enthusiastic that I spent nearly the entire weekend coding. I intentionally avoided AI tools like ChatGPT because I wanted to independently understand what I was doing, which proved highly beneficial for my process. However, after exploring most of the functions I wanted, the workflow became somewhat repetitive due to constantly commenting code in and out. I realized I was focusing too much on producing a "good" drum and bass set that I forgot creation is about the process, not just the result and I started building in more random components and to partake in creating visuals, creating a snippet inspired by Jasmin's work.

I really enjoyed the collaborative group work and co-creation with Dominique. The visuals perfectly complement the performance by representing flocks of objects in cohesion and separation, mirroring the people from commonwealth countries invited to England after WWII. And how they gathered around autonomous sound systems as a response to hostility and exclusion, they formed something beautiful, drum and bass.

<https://blog.history.ac.uk/2023/12/learning-from-the-windrush-scandal-oral-history-archives/>

<https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/full/10.1177/03063968221081417>

<https://www.history.ac.uk/research/history-policy/windrush-scandal-transnational-commonwealth-context>